

Agriculture

(1)

Types of Farming

- Primitive Subsistence Farming
 - practised on small patches of land with primitive tools like hoe, dao & digging sticks and family labour.
 - depends upon monsoon, natural fertility of soil
 - 'slash and burn' agriculture.
 - farmers clear land, produce crops, soil fertility decreases, shifts to another land, nature replenish fertility of soil, land productivity is low
 - called as Jhumming in NE states — Assam, Meghalaya, Mizoram & Nagaland
 - Pamlou — Manipur, Dipa — Bastar (CG) & AN Islands
 - Bewar or Dahya — MP, Podu or Penda — Andhra Pradesh
 - Pama Dabi or Koman or Bringa — Orissa
 - Kumari — Western Ghats, Valre or Walbe — SE Rajasthan
 - Khil — Himalayan Belt, Kuruma — JH
- Intensive Subsistence Farming
 - practised in areas of high population pressure on land
 - labour intensive, higher production through irrigation & biochemical inputs
- Commercial Farming
 - higher doses of modern inputs e.g. HYV seeds, chemical fertilisers etc.

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- Plantation = single crop on a large area
 - ↳ interface of agriculture and industry
 - ↳ cover large tracts of land, using capital intensive inputs & migrant labourers
 - ↳ Tea, coffee, rubber, sugarcane, banana etc.
 - ↳ Tea = Assam & North Bengal
 - Coffee = Karnataka

→ Cropping Pattern (3 Cropping seasons)
↳ Rabi, Kharif & Zaid

→ Rabi

- Sown in winter & from Oct to Dec & harvested in summer from April to June
- wheat, Barley, Peas, Gram & Mustard
- States from N & NW parts = Punjab, Haryana, HP, J&K, UK & UP
- Availability of precipitation during winter months due to western temperate helps in success of these crops
- Success of Green Revolution an imp factor

→ Kharif

- grown with onset of monsoon ~~in~~ and harvested in Sep-Oct
- Paddy, maize, Jowar, Bajra, tur (Arhar), moong, urad, cotton, Jute, Groundnut & Soyabean
- rice-growing regions = Assam, WB, coastal regions of Orissa, AP, TN, Kerala, MH (Konkan coast), UP & Bihar
- Recently, Punjab & Haryana = Paddy

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- Assam, WB & Orissa = 3 crops of Paddy are grown in a year (Aus, Aman & Boro)

→ Zaid

- B/w Rabi & Kharif, short season during summer months
- Watermelon, muskmelon, cucumbers, vegetables and fodder crops

→ Major crops of India

i Rice

- staple food crop of majority of India, 2nd largest producer after China
- Kharif crop, requires high Temp (above 25°C), high humidity, annual rainfall above 100 cm
- grown in plains of North & NE India, coastal areas and deltaic regions.
- Irrigation helped in areas of less rainfall such as Punjab, Haryana & western UP & parts of Rajasthan

ii Wheat

- 2nd most imp cereal crop, main food crop in N & NW India
- requires cool growing season & bright sunshine at time of ripening, 50-75 cm of annual rainfall
- 2 imp wheat growing zones = Ganga-Satlej plains in NW & black soil region of Deccan
- Punjab, Haryana, UP, Bihar, Rajasthan & parts of MP

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(iii) Millets

- Sorghum, Bajra & ragi are imp millets in India.
- coarse grains (very high nutritional value)
- Ragi = Rich in Iron, calcium, other micronutrients & roughage
- Sorghum = 3rd most imp food crop w.r.t area & production
- Rain-fed crop grown in moist areas, MH with highest production, KN, AP & MP
- Bajra = grows well on sandy soil & shallow black soil, Rajasthan largest producer, UP, MH, Gujarat & Haryana
- Ragi = grown in dry regions in Red, black, sandy, loamy and shallow black soils
 ↳ KN largest producer, TN, HP, UK, Sikkim, JH & Arunachal Pradesh

(iv) Maize

- used as both food & fodder, Kharif crop
- requires temp b/w 21°C to 27°C , grows in old alluvial soil
- Bihar (grown in Rabi season also)
- modern inputs increased production of maize
- KN, UP, Bihar, AP & MP

(v) Pulses

- India is largest producer as well as consumer
- major source of protein in veg diet
- tur (arhar), Urad, Moong, Masur, peas & gram
- need less moisture, can survive in dry conditions

- leguminous crops, except arhar, help in restoring soil fertility by fixing nitrogen from air
- grown in rotation with other crops
- MP, UP, Rajasthan, MH & KN

→ Food crops other than grains

(i) Sugarcane

- tropical as well as subtropical crop, grows well in hot & humid climate with temp of 21°C to 27°C , annual rainfall (75-100 cm)
- can be grown on variety of soils, India is 2nd largest producer of sugarcane after Brazil
- main source of sugar, gur (jaggery), khandasari and molasses
- UP, MH, KN, TN, AP, Bihar, Punjab & Haryana

(ii) Oil seeds

- largest producer of oil seeds in world
- 12% of total cropped area of India
- Groundnut, mustard, coconut, sesamum (oil), soyabean, castor seeds, cotton seeds, linseed and sunflower (most are edible & used in cooking)
- some are used as raw material in production of soap, cosmetics and ointments
- Groundnut (kharif) = half of major oilseeds of India
- AP, TN, KN, GS, MH
- Linseed & Mustard (Rabi)

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- Sesamum = Kharif in North & Rabi in South
- Castor seeds = grown as both Rabi & Kharif

iii Tea

- plantation Agriculture, beverage crop
- grows well in tropical & sub-tropical climates with deep and fertile well-drained soil, rich in humus and organic matter
- requires warm and moist frost-free climate through the year, labour intensive industry (abundant, cheap and skilled labour)
- Assam, hills of Darjeeling & Jalpaiguri districts, WB, TN & Kerala also HP, UK, Meghalaya, AP & Tripura
- leading producer as well as exporter of tea in world

iv Coffee

- India produces about 4% of world's coffee production
- Arabica (origin Yemen) produced in India
- Cultivation introduced on Baba Budan hills and confined to Nilgiri in KN, Kerala & TN

v Horticulture crops

- largest producer of fruits & vegetables (tropical as well as temperate)
- Mangoes = MH, AP, UP & WB
- oranges = Nagpur & Cherrapunjee (Meghalaya)
- Bananas = Kerala, Mizoram, MH & TN
- Lichi & Guava = UP & Bihar

Pine apples = Meghalaya

Grapes = Andhra Pradesh & MH

Apples, pears, apricots & walnuts = J&K and HP

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→ Non-Food Crops

(i) Rubber

- equatorial crop, grown in tropical and sub-tropical areas (under specific conditions)
- requires moist and humid climate, rainfall of more than 200 cm, temp. above 25°C
- 'imp' industrial raw material
- Kerala, TN, KN, A & N islands, Garo hills of Meghalaya
- India ranks 5th among world's natural rubber producers

(ii) Fibre crops

- 4 major fibre crops = Cotton, Jute, Hemp & Natural silk (cocoon of silkworms - fed mulberry green leaves)
= Sericulture

(A) Cotton

- 3rd largest producer of cotton, grows well in drier parts of black cotton soil of Deccan plateau
- requires high temp, light rainfall, 210 frost-free days & bright sun-shine for its growth
- Kharif crop, requires 6-8 months to mature
- MH, GJ, MP, KN, AP, TN, Punjab, Haryana & UP

(B) Jute (Golden Fibre)

- grows well on well-drained fertile soils in flood plains as soils renewed
- High temp at time of growth
- WB, Bihar, Assam, Orissa & Meghalaya

THE DEFENSE USTAAD